

Element B: Documentation and Analysis of Prior Solution Attempts

Dogs are getting into indoor trash cans, making messes, creating health risks, and causing inconvenience for dog owners and people inside the home. This problem involves dog owners, the dogs themselves, and other people inside the home. This happens inside the house nearly every day. Dogs dig in the trash because they are attracted to the food and smells inside of the trash cans. This is a small but persistent issue that leaves owners irritated.

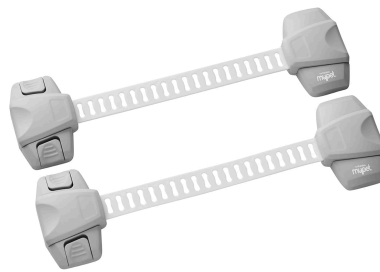
One of the first attempts at solving the problem is a no chew spray. The spray has a bitter taste that dogs do not like. You can spray it on furniture, shoes, or in this case, the trash. It is safe for the dogs and their owners, and it keeps dogs from digging in the trash (petco.com, 2026). Although the spray works for most dogs, some dogs like the smell making them more likely to dig in the trash. The spray might also not last long, and the dogs would eventually chew up the trash. These would not address the needs because the dog could still get it.



(Bitter spray \$17.00)

The strap locks for trash cans are also another solution. It is a strap lock that mounts on to the side and top of a trash can. You click the two buttons on the end and

the strap comes undone (Amazon.com, 2026). This keeps dogs out of the trash can, and it can also work on doors and toilets. Some trash cans do not have lids, so these straplocks are not universal for all trash cans. You also have to cut the strap to size which may be dangerous if not done properly. These would not address the needs because the dog could still get it, and it may not be safe.



(Strap Locks 13.00)

This trash can is the final prior solution. It is a stainless steel trash can that has a sensor built into it. When you wave your hand above the sensor it opens. It stays locked and it leaves a good smelling odor that masks the scent of the garbage (walmart.com, 2026). The dog could probably set the sensor off and it would open.



(Sensor Trash can \$100)

Our stakeholder is currently solving the problem by closing the bathroom and bedroom doors. The closed doors keep the dog out well, and the dog does not try to get in the rooms. There are a few issues such as, not all of the trash cans are in closable rooms, and the stakeholder is sometimes in a rush and forgets to close the door. This can harm the dogs if they get in the trash and chew something that is bad for them, and it does not always prevent them from getting to the trash. The door is durable enough where the dog can not get through.



(Closed door)

References:

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